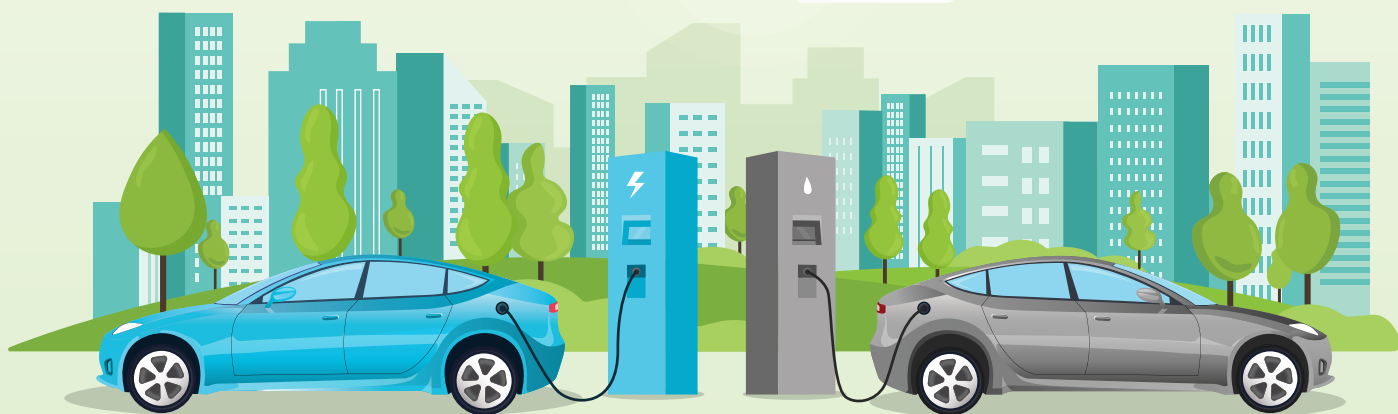




IS INDIA'S FUTURE REALLY ELECTRIC?

Electric Vehicle sales have steadily risen in India over the past few years. Are they, however, a feasible investment in our fossil-fuel hungry nation? Read on to find out.

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In today's day and age where climate change and consistently rising global crude oil prices are a hotly debated

topic, Electric Vehicles arise as one of the first and foremost solutions to the problem. There was a surge in the sales of Electric Vehicles from 2020 onwards, with 3.1 million units being sold globally in that year. In 2021 too, in the first six months alone, 2.5 million units were sold globally. Closer home, India also saw a concurrent rise in EV sales with 3,29,190 EVs being sold, a 168 percent increase over 2020's 1,22,607.

The above numbers point towards EVs possibly being the future of mobility.

At the same time, one must bear in mind that EVs accounted for only 0.4 percent of the total vehicle sales in India between January and October 2021, whereas conventionally powered petrol and diesel vehicles accounted for 74.1 and 18.4 percent respectively. Even CNG, the preferred fuel type for eco-friendly mobility in India, accounted for 7.1 percent of total vehicle sales in India.

To help you make a more balanced decision of whether to switch to an EV in India at this point in time, we decided to put together a list of possible rea-

sons for the yet constrained growth of EV sales in India.



RANGE AND CHARGING ANXIETY:

Options to choose from long range EVs in the Indian market are plenty - the Audi E-Tron with 484km range, the highest in India currently, the Jaguar i-Pace with a 470 km range, Hyundai Kona with a 452 km range, MG ZS EV with a range of 419 kms, the Mercedes Benz EQC with 414 kms of range, and Tata with their Nexon and Tigor EVs, with a range of 312 and 306 kms respectively. However, priced between ₹99 lakh and ₹1.12 crore, cars such as the E-Tron, EQC, and the Jaguar i-Pace are, for the most part, out of the common man's reach, which leaves buyers with very few affordable options in the long range EV market.

Besides the problem of a scarcity of affordable, truly long range EVs in general, there lies another, perhaps bigger issue. It was revealed in a response

to a question in the Lok Sabha by Raj Kumar Singh, Union Minister of Power, that as of December 2021, India had only 1028 public EV charging stations. Furthermore, the majority of them are concentrated in states with major urban agglomerations such as Delhi (322), Maharashtra (88), Tamil Nadu (94), and so on. This means that in addition to range anxiety, EV owners are also faced with what is referred to as "charge anxiety" which refers to apprehension of whether they will make it to the next charging station in time or not. As per guidelines from the Ministry of Power, there should be at least one EV charging station every 25 kms on both sides of a national highway. For long range and heavy duty EVs, one such charging station must be on both sides of the highway every 100 kms. However, the aforementioned targets have not yet been achieved. Indian Oil Corporation Limited and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited have pledged to set up 10,000 and 7000 EV charging stations respectively at their petrol pumps in the next three years. Another 2,877 EV charging stations in 68 cities across 25 UTs and States have also been sanctioned, but charging and range anxiety remain pressing concerns for prospective EV buyers.

Although 1000 of the total ₹10,000 crore budget allocation to Phase-II of